also be transformed into one of the most expensive pieces of real estate in Mumbai. "While slum-dwellers who came before 2000 will get free housing, residents who came between 2000 and 2011 will get it at a concessional rate.... We'll have a rental housing scheme on a hire-and-purchase basis for those who came after," says S.V.R. Srinivas, CEO of the Dharavi Redevelopment Project (DRP).

Efforts will be made to construct this rental housing in Dharavi itself, but in case the land falls short, they will be shifted to areas in the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR) within a radius of 10 km. Authorised commercial units will get an equivalent space. While the rehabilitation component is expected to be completed in seven years, the resale component, that is properties to be sold in the open market, will be built in 18 years. Further, Fadnavis has also said that industries in Dharavi will be rehabilitated and provided with common facility centres (CFCs), a five-year tax holiday and GST refunds. Some residents in Dharavi have flats that measure over 750 sq. ft, and Fadnavis has assured them of larger houses.

It's not an easy undertaking, though. The largest Slum Rehabilitation Authority (SRA) project in Mumbai so far, at Chandivali, covered around 10,000 hutments. Compare that to the 70,000 structures (at last count in 2007-08) in Dharavi, and the sheer scale of the challenge becomes clear. During the winter session of the state legislature in December 2022, Fadnavis told the assembly that Dharavi had 46,191 residential units eligible for rehabilitation and 12,974 commercial units—59,165 units in total. However, officials say the figures are from a 2007-'08 survey, and that the number may be around 100,000 now. The population, too, is estimated at about a million, around a 10th of Mumbai's 12.5 million population. Apart from this, there are 4,818 slum-dwellers on railway land, also eligible for rehabilitation. Railway quarters are to be redeveloped and the people accommodated in 84,649 sq. m of built-up area.

Srinivas says once the SPV is formed, a survey will be conducted to determine the number of eligible slum-dwellers and, the land to be utilised as the rehabilitation component and that for open-market sale will be determined. "This is an extremely challenging project. In fact, 'challenge' is an understatement. It is humongous. No project of this scale has been conceptualised or executed in the world," he says. The construction cost is expected to cross Rs 20,000 crore. Work is expected to begin by the end of the year. The project is based on the principle of using land as a resource. This means that Adani Properties will spend around Rs 20,000 crore for the construction and recover its costs from the open market sale component.

Realty experts, too, point to the myriad opportunities on the horizon. Pankaj Kapoor, MD of Liases Foras Real Estate Rating & Research Pvt. Ltd, describes it as "a promising project with a complex set-up because it is not (just) a housing project, it is like a city within a city", only one with massive economic activity. Industry stakeholders say tentative prices of residential and office spaces in Dharavi may be in the range of Rs 25,000 to 40,000 per sq. ft after the redevelopment. This means, initially, resale spaces may be available at dis-

DHARAVI NEEDS AN EMPATHETIC URBAN PLANNING APPROACH FOR ITS MANY COMPLEXITIES. REHABILITATION MUST GET PRIORITY

'REDEVELOPMENT MUST UPLIFT THE COMMUNITY'

SAMYA KORDE, 23 ▶
Student of law and urban planning and political activist

The women and the elderly have to bear the brunt when it comes to issues such as sanitation, water and electricity. Public toilets and community water taps are our life. The toilets are dirty and many shut down after 11.30 pm. And if the toilets on the main roads are open, women face harassment from goons and drug addicts. Lack of proper sanitisation facilities has also led to the spread of diseases like dengue and malaria. Planned redevelopment will provide relief, but it must be done through sustainable methods and uplift the community. Just converting horizontal structures into vertical ones is not redevelopment. The local communities will benefit if socioeconomic factors are taken into consideration.



Photographs by MILIND SHELTE